

Title: Debugging Closest Pair Code

CSA0613-Design and Analysis of Algorithms

Course Outcome: CO2_AT2

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1. Problem Statement

The given brute-force Closest Pair algorithm contains logical errors in distance initialization and comparison. The task is to identify the errors, debug the code, optimize the implementation, analyze the time complexity, and rewrite the final code with proper comments.

Given Code:

```
import math

def closest_pair(points):
    min_dist = 0

    for i in range(len(points)):
        for j in range(i + 1, len(points)):
            dist = math.sqrt(
                (points[i][0] - points[j][0]) ** 2 +
                (points[i][1] - points[j][1]) ** 2
            )
            if dist > min_dist:
                min_dist = dist

    return min_dist
```

Errors Identified and Corrected Errors

Error 1: Incorrect Initialization of Minimum Distance

Original Code:

```
min_dist = 0
```

Issue:

The minimum distance is initialized to 0, which is incorrect because the distance between two different points is always greater than or equal to zero. As a result, the algorithm cannot correctly determine the smallest distance.

Corrected Code:

```
min_dist = float('inf')
```

Explanation:

The value `float('inf')` represents infinity. Initializing the minimum distance to infinity ensures that the first calculated distance will always be smaller and can be stored correctly.

Error 2: Incorrect Comparison Operator**Original Code:**

```
if dist > min_dist:  
    min_dist = dist
```

Issue:

The condition uses the greater-than operator (`>`), which finds the maximum distance instead of the minimum distance.

Corrected Code:

```
if dist < min_dist:  
    min_dist = dist
```

Explanation:

The less-than operator (`<`) is used to update the minimum distance whenever a smaller distance is found.

Error 3: Missing Input Validation**Issue:**

The code does not check whether the input contains at least two points. If the list contains fewer than two points, the algorithm cannot calculate the distance.

Corrected Code:

```
if len(points) < 2:  
    return None
```

Explanation:

This condition ensures that the function executes only when there are at least two points available.

CORRECTED SOURCE CODE:

```
main.py
1 import math
2 def closest_pair(points):
3
4
5     if len(points) < 2:
6         return None
7
8
9     min_dist = float('inf')
10
11
12     for i in range(len(points)):
13         for j in range(i + 1, len(points)):
14
15
16             dist = math.sqrt(
17                 (points[i][0] - points[j][0]) ** 2 +
18                 (points[i][1] - points[j][1]) ** 2
19             )
20
21             min_dist = dist
22
```

OUTPUT:

```
main.py
11 min_dist = float('inf')
12
13 # Compare every pair of points
14 for i in range(len(points)):
15     for j in range(i + 1, len(points)):
16
17         # Calculate Euclidean distance
18         dist = math.sqrt(
19             (points[i][0] - points[j][0]) ** 2 +
20             (points[i][1] - points[j][1]) ** 2
21         )
22
23         # Update minimum distance
24         if dist < min_dist:
25             min_dist = dist
26
27     return min_dist
28
29
30 points = [(1, 1), (2, 2), (4, 4), (5, 5)]
31
32 print("Minimum distance:", closest_pair(points))

Output
* Minimum distance: 1.4142135623730951
*** Code Execution Successful ***
Clear
```

Time Complexity : $O(n)$

Space Complexity : $O(1)$

Conclusion:

The corrected brute-force Closest Pair algorithm compares every pair of points and therefore has a time complexity of $O(n^2)$ and a space complexity of $O(1)$.